

# 30 Minutes Expert Melodies from Afar

Control your music, wherever you are

**Scenario 1:** You have 1 GB of music on your PC, but need to work on another PC for a while. You do miss your music, but don't want to wait for hours as the songs are copied to your current PC. And what if you needed to use yet another PC? Also, you want to control what you listen to.

**Scenario 2:** You want to hear your music on your colleague's speakers over the cubicle.

**Scenario 3:** Your boss has an FM card in his PC, and you want to listen to the radio on your PC. What do you do?

All you need is Winamp (any version except 3.x), SHOUTcast Distributed Network Audio Servers (DNAS), the SHOUTcast Digital Sound Processing (DSP) plugin and Sound-Requester plugin. SHOUTcast ([www.shoutcast.com](http://www.shoutcast.com)) is a software allowing people to broadcast audio, for others to connect and listen to.

## STEP 1 Stirring up your own music

Install Winamp. Apart from playing music, it allows you to arrange and catalogue your music in the order you prefer. You can also create playlists.

## STEP 2 Blowing your own trumpet

You now need to install SHOUTcast DNAS, which allows your PC to serve music to other computers. Go



If you want your audience to also view song titles, then in SHOUTcast DSP options, click 'Enable Title Updates' and set all to 'Auto' in the Output tab's 'Yellow pages' section.



If you have a secondary audio source feeding your PC, such as a TV tuner card or FM radio, you can select 'Soundcard Input' in the Input tab to stream this audio. You need to hook the device's sound output to your PC's Line-In jack first.

to the newly-created program group for 'SHOUTcast DNAS', and click 'Edit SHOUTcast DNAS configuration'. A .ini file opens with a number of configurable options. The important ones are:

■ **MaxUser:** The number of people you'll broadcast to. A higher number means more system resources and bandwidth.

■ **PortBase:** Set this to a free port on your PC, such as 8000.

■ **Password:** Set a password for Winamp to connect to the DNAS interface.

Save the file, and click on 'SHOUTcast DNAS (GUI)' in the SHOUTcast program group to start the software. It's now ready to accept audio outputted by software such as Winamp on

your PC.

## STEP 3 Signals to the outer world

Close Winamp, if it's running, and install the DSP plugin. Now open Winamp Preferences, go to **Plugins** > **DSP/Effect** and click 'Nullsoft SHOUTcast Source DSP...' to configure it.

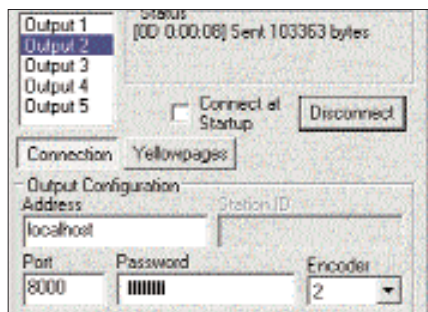
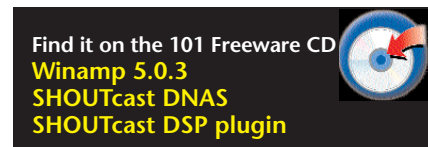
In **Output**, click **Connection**, and select **Output 1**. Enter 'localhost' in 'Address', '8000' in 'Port', '1' as 'Encoder', and the password you set in the DNAS .ini file.

Next, in the **Encoder** tab, select **Encoder 1**, and set what quality you wish to stream at. If you're low on resources, select lower quality. If it's going to be just a few people, increase the quality.

Now, return to the **Output** tab and click **Connect**. The status should change



To enforce the same volume across songs during playback, you may want to use a plugin such as Zyrrax's Evil Volume Normalizer ([www.winamp.com/plugins/details.php?id=79888](http://www.winamp.com/plugins/details.php?id=79888)). To use more than one DSP plugin at the same time, use DSP Stacker ([www.specialaudio.com](http://www.specialaudio.com)).



The Winamp DSP plugin shows you the running status of the time and bytes sent

from 'Not Connected', to a running display of the time and bytes sent.

Your PC is now ready to serve. Whatever you play in Winamp, can be listened to by people who connect to your PC on your IP. If your IP is 128.128.0.147, people can connect to your station via Winamp at <http://128.128.0.147:8000/listen.pls> through Winamp's 'Play URL' feature.

## STEP 4 The 'I can control thee' thing

Install the Song Requester plugin ([http://www.oddsock.org/tools/gen\\_songrequester/](http://www.oddsock.org/tools/gen_songrequester/)), which you can configure so your Winamp can be controlled from any PC on the network, via a Web interface. You will need to specify a password in the plugin configuration screen. Once installed, if your IP is 128.128.0.147, visit <http://128.128.0.147/admin.cgi> and click 'Refresh Playlist Cache'.

Now, you can go to any PC on your network, and visit that URL to do the play, pause, stop or skip operations

on any track. □

SAURABH KUMAR  
[saurabh\\_kumar@thinkdigit.com](mailto:saurabh_kumar@thinkdigit.com)